Week 11 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, December 2 – 5, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 11 · after Thanksgiving week off

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (33–36), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: In from the dark ivy hopped a / Wee small bird: and that was Me.

Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. Polish both verses; add verse 3 only if they're easy. Optional: say "Old Shellover" by heart.

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today" — stanzas 1 and 2

Folk song: "The Bold Grenadier" — the clearer sing-along recording on the shelf page

Math: Ray's Lessons 33–36. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 18	Exodus 34 + Awana	Our Island Story ch. 31, Thomas à Becket	Ray's L33 · copywork · hymn · "The Little Bird" · Betsy (pm)
Thu 19	Exodus 35:1–36:7 + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 6 first half (sitting 1)	Harvey's · Tree in the Trail ch. 9 · folk
Fri 20	hymn (lighter Bible)	Little Duke (sitting 2) · Burgess ch. 11	Grimm · picture study · composer · place cards · Betsy (pm)
Sat 21	Luke 22:14–38	Understood Betsy ch. 10 (sitting 3)	Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress · CHOW "A Great Adventure"

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy; references only)
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 33–36
- Harvey's Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two sittings
- *Our Island Story* ch. 31 · *Little Duke* ch. 6a (printed)
- *Tree in the Trail* ch. 9 — **your copy** (catch-up)
- Hillyer CHOW — "A Great Adventure," **your copy**
- *Burgess* ch. 11 (12 opt.) · *Betsy* ch. 10 · Grimm's Pantheon
- Awana workbook (Wed + Thu) · McGuffey for Tracy

Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, pictures, Grimm, the place cards, and outside (see her page).

Weather

Late November: cold fronts, a chance of the first frost, bright afternoons. Times slide; keep the order.

This week's shifts

Betsy ch. 10 is long, so it gets three sittings (Wed and Fri afternoons, Sat morning). **Little Duke** gets two (Thu + Fri). Thanksgiving week (Nov 25–28) was off; Week 12 is Dec 9–12.

Readings and page numbers

Every public-domain sitting is printed in full. Edition pages let you find the same place in any copy of that edition; packet pages find it here.

DAY	READING	EDITION · PAGES	THIS PACKET
Wed	Our Island Story ch. 31 · Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Thomas à Becket	Stokes / Constable, pp. 145–151	**pp. 11–14**
Wed	"The Little Bird" (de la Mare)	Constable 1924, p. 18	**p. 15**
Wed pm · Fri pm · Sat	Understood Betsy ch. 10 · Betsy Has a Birthday (three sittings)	Henry Holt 1917, pp. 201–233	**pp. 16–23**
Thu + Fri	The Little Duke ch. 6, first half (two sittings)	Macmillan, pp. 102–114	**pp. 27–29**
Fri	Burgess Animal Book ch. 11 · A Fellow With a Thousand Spears	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 90–98	**pp. 34–36**
Fri (opt.)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 12 · A Lumberman and Engineer	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 99–111	**pp. 37–40**
Sat	The Pilgrim's Progress · the man in the iron cage, the dream of the Judgment, farewell to the Interpreter	Dent 1910, pp. 36–39	**pp. 45–46**

FROM YOUR OWN SHELF · NOT PRINTED

- **Bible (ESV)** — Exodus 34 (Wed) · Exodus 35:1–36:7 (Thu; 36:8–38 optional) · Luke 22:14–38 (Sat). References only.
- **Tree in the Trail** (Holling) — ch. 9 (Thu).
- **A Child's History of the World** (Hillyer) — "A Great Adventure" (ch. 53 in newer printings, ch. 51 in the 1924 first edition) (Sat).
- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 33, 34, 35, 36, one a day.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — next lesson, Thu and Sat.
- **Grimm's Fairy Tales** (Pantheon) — one gentle tale by title (Fri).
- **Awana workbook** — next page, Wed and Thu after Bible.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's picture pages, any day.

Page numbers come from the Internet Archive scans of each named edition (checked Nov 2, 2026). Other printings of the same book may run a page or two different.

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 9 (~15–20 min, Thursday). Weeks 3–10 were ch. 1–8. Keep going in order; do **not** jump to AO Week 11's ch. 16. Never reprint.

Hillyer, A Child's History of the World — "A Great Adventure" (ch. 53 modern / ch. 51 1st ed) on Saturday, from your copy. It comes right after Week 10's "A Pirate's Great Grandson." Never reprint.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — resting. Next chapter (Bernard of Clairvaux) comes in Term 2.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until around Week 19.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 33–36; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm's Pantheon** — one gentle tale by title (suggested: "The Fisherman and His Wife"). Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

FOLK SONG · THE CLEARER RECORDING

Keep using the plain sing-along "Bold Grenadier" that AmblesideOnline links: **youtu.be/9U631tf08sM** (folksandhymns channel). AO's November song is "The Rising of the Moon" and its November hymn is "When Morning Gilds the Skies." If "Bold Grenadier" and the hymn are both easy now, you may switch; otherwise stay put. There's no hurry.

BUY-AHEAD · WEEKS 12–14

Nothing to buy. Week 12 (Dec 9–12) and Term 2's first weeks use public-domain readings (printed in the packets) and books you already own: Hillyer, *Tree in the Trail*, and *Trial and Triumph* (Bernard of Clairvaux, about Week 13). Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* is still around Weeks 22–25, so it's too early to buy. *Seabird* is already on your shelf for about Week 19.

Calendar: Thanksgiving week (Nov 25–28) was off. Week 12 is Dec 9–12.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 One reading, one telling

Read the passage once, at a good pace, and close the book. If she knows you won't read it again, she listens the first time. Let her tell it back in her own words and order.

02 A hard death, plainly read

Becket's death in the cathedral is the hardest scene this week. Read it plainly and stop. Don't explain who was right. Children can hold a sad true story and think about it on their own. Answer what she asks, and nothing more.

03 A long chapter, three sittings

Betsy's birthday chapter is the longest so far. Three short sittings beat one long one. Stop each time while she still wants to know what happens.

04 Let the pictures speak

Pilgrim's Progress is all pictures: a cage, a dream, a man trembling. Ask her to tell the pictures. She doesn't need to explain what they mean.

05 Masterly inactivity

Cold mornings and bright afternoons are made for free play outside. Don't steer it. Unplanned outdoor time counts as part of the school day too.

06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, the place cards, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

07 Copywork with a slash

This week's line runs over two lines of the poem; the slash marks where the poem breaks. She can copy it as two lines. One careful try is the lesson; if the letters get sloppy, stop and try again tomorrow.

08 Before the break

Last week was Thanksgiving with no school. End Saturday on something she loves. A week off doesn't undo the habits she's built.

How to teach this week

Island Story ch. 31. Little Duke begins ch. 6. Exodus 34–36 and Luke 22. CHOW from your shelf on Saturday.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 34 (new tablets; the LORD passes by and proclaims His name; Moses' face shines). Thursday: Exodus 35:1–36:7 (the people bring gifts for the tabernacle until Moses has to tell them to stop); 36:8–38 lists how it was built, so read it later or skip it. Saturday: Luke 22:14–38 (the Last Supper; who is the greatest; Peter warned). Friday: lighter, hymn first. ESV, physical copy only. **Pre-read:** Luke 22:14–20 is the Lord's Supper. Talk about it the way your family and church do.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible, next page, physical book. Never reprint. No Awana Fri or Sat.

03 Ray's Lessons 33–36

After Week 10's Lessons 29–32. One lesson a day, oral first. Do not dump pages.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "The Little Bird": *In from the dark ivy hopped a / Wee small bird: and that was Me.* Point out the colon and the capital M in "Me." Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 (ESV, reference only).

05 Island Story ch. 31 · Thomas à Becket

Printed (about 1,800 words; optional break at "After a time Henry forgave Thomas"). Henry and his merry chancellor, the tug-of-war over the cloak, Becket made archbishop, the quarrel, and the four knights. **Intensity (pre-read):** Becket is killed in Canterbury Cathedral. It's brief and not gory, but it is a killing.

06 Tree in the Trail, ch. 9

From **your copy**, Thursday, ~15–20 min. Catch-up (Weeks 3–10 were ch. 1–8); not AO's ch. 16. Never reprint.

07 Little Duke, ch. 6 first half · two sittings

Printed (about 2,100 words). **Thursday:** leaving Rouen, the King's kindness on the road, the dreary journey through forests and marshes. **Friday** (from "Thus they travelled"): Laon, the cold Queen, and the princes Lothaire and Carloman. The second half (supper and bedtime) is Week 12.

08 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu, Sat), next lesson. Oral and light.

09 Grimm by title only

From your Pantheon: "The Fisherman and His Wife" suggested (alternates "The Star-Money," "Sweet Porridge"). Never reprint.

10 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 11, "A Fellow With a Thousand Spears," is the week's chapter: Prickly Porky the Porcupine. If you read it as Week 10's optional, review briefly and go on to ch. 12, "A Lumberman and Engineer" (Paddy the Beaver; printed, optional). Not AO's ch. 14.

11 CHOW · A Great Adventure (Saturday)

From **your copy** (ch. 53 modern / ch. 51 1st ed). Hillyer's chapter on the First Crusade. Pre-read it; there are battles. Never reprint.

12 What you are not doing

No Shakespeare, Trial and Triumph (Term 2), Cooper, Seabird (~Week 19), Parables from Nature, or Wind in the Willows.

How to teach this week

Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, Hillyer, late-November riches, and a handicraft for the Thanksgiving table.

13 Understood Betsy, ch. 10 · three sittings

"Betsy Has a Birthday." About 5,700 words, so read it in three sittings at the marked breaks. **Wed pm:** the Fair, the birthday money, Molly. **Fri pm** (from "Betsy stopped short"): left behind, eight miles from home, and Betsy looking for work. **Sat** (from "Betsy mounted on a soap box"): washing dishes for train fare, the ride home, and the family's pride. A worrying middle, a very happy ending.

14 Pilgrim's Progress · the last rooms

The man in the iron cage of despair; a man who dreamed of the Judgment and woke trembling; then Christian leaves the Interpreter. About 1,300 words; may stop after the iron cage. **Pre-read:** the Judgment dream has fire and a pit. It's short, but it can frighten a sensitive child. Next: the Cross, where the burden falls off (Week 12).

15 Poetry: "The Little Bird"

De la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. A merry house-warming party, and when it's over, in hops a little bird, "and that was Me." A poem about being born. Both children. Copywork from the last two lines.

16 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

She studies *ivy*, *hopped*, and *small*, then writes the line as you say it once. Five minutes; skip if tired.

17 Term 1 riches

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today," st. 1–2. Folk: "The Bold Grenadier" (clearer recording, shelf page). Picture: Rockwell, *Saying Grace* (1951), next on AO's list and just right before Thanksgiving; look, turn it over, describe it. Composer: Bernstein, *On the Waterfront* Symphonic Suite (1954), next on AO's list; play the quiet opening while she draws. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

18 Nature · Lost Pines, late November

Fall color peaks now in the Lost Pines: sweetgum, red oaks, and sumac against the green loblollies. Robins and cedar waxwings come in flocks to the yaupon and possumhaw berries. Listen for sandhill cranes. A first frost is possible. Look for squirrels burying acorns and, near the river, beaver-chewed stumps like Paddy's. One dated drawing, one scribed sentence.

19 Handicraft · Thanksgiving place cards

Wednesday: gather small leaves, acorn caps, and pine needles. Friday: fold index cards, write each person's name in best handwriting, and glue on one treasure. Twenty minutes. Tracy picks the treasures.

20 Preschool corner

Tracy's informal page is in this packet. Stories, songs, a little-bird game, McGuffey nearby, no worksheets.

21 Intensity / preview

Heavier than Week 10 in two places: Becket's death (Wed) and the Judgment dream (Sat). Pre-read both. Week 12 (Dec 9–12): Exodus 37–40, Luke 22:39–46, Island Story ch. 32, Little Duke ch. 6 second half, Betsy ch. 11. AO's optional Term 1 exam week comes after Week 12.

Tracy’s week

She joins what fits. She is not expected to narrate, copy, or sit through math.

01 Join freely

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she’ll sit), the hymn and “The Bold Grenadier,” “The Little Bird,” the porcupine (and beaver) chapters, the Grimm tale, picture study, the music, and the place cards.

02 Nearby during hard work

McGuffey Pictorial Primer picture-pages, a busy-hands basket, or quiet play while Astoria does Ray’s, copywork, Island Story, Little Duke, CHOW, or Harvey’s.

03 Little-bird game

After the poem, Tracy curls up behind a cushion “in the ivy.” When everyone is “still as still can be,” she hops out, and someone says, “and that was Tracy!” Once or twice, then stop.

04 Awana days

She may listen near Bible and Awana on Wed and Thu, or play in the same room. She does not do the workbook.

05 Outside is her classroom

Late November Lost Pines: red and gold leaves, spiky sweetgum balls, robins in the yaupon (look at the berries, don’t eat them), maybe frost on the grass in the morning. Name one thing each day.

06 Place cards

She chooses an acorn cap or a leaf for each card on Friday. Her card can have her picture instead of her name.

07 Porcupine hands

After Burgess, she spreads her fingers like quills and waddles slowly, the way Prickly Porky does. Then stop.

08 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she’s fussy, the morning keeps its order and nothing more is added.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 33) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 31 (printed) · "The Little Bird" · a bag for small treasures · *Understood Betsy* ch. 10 (afternoon) · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk + treasure hunt** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Collect small leaves, acorn caps, and pine needles for Friday's place cards. Look at the fall color.

8:25 — **Bible · Exodus 34**

Open your ESV to Exodus 34. New tablets, the LORD passing by, and Moses' shining face. Read once, close the Bible, narrate, then stop.

8:40 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.

8:55 — **Hymn** TRACY JOINS

"I Bind Unto Myself Today," stanzas 1–2. Sing it; don't explain it.

9:05 — **Ray's · Lesson 33**

Next lesson after Week 10's Lesson 32. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.

9:25 — **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *In from the dark ivy hopped a / Wee small bird: and that was Me.* Recitation: Genesis 1:1–2 from your ESV (wording not printed).

9:40 — **History · Island Story ch. 31**

"The Story of Thomas à Becket." Printed. About 13 min, or stop at the marked break and finish Thursday. Narrate. **Stop.** (Pre-read the ending.)

10:00 — **Poem · "The Little Bird"** TRACY JOINS

Read once. Both children. Then Tracy's little-bird game, once. *Afternoon:* Betsy ch. 10, sitting 1 (~12 min).

How to teach Wednesday

> **Island Story ch. 31.** Printed in full. It ends with Becket’s death, so pre-read the last page. Betsy’s first sitting is an afternoon read-aloud.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 34. Moses cuts two new tablets and goes up the mountain again. The LORD passes by and proclaims His name: merciful and gracious, slow to anger. He renews the covenant. When Moses comes down, his face shines, so he puts a veil over it. One reading; let her narrate. Awana after Bible, physical book only.

Ray’s Lesson 33

Pick up the Mott Ray’s where Week 10 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she’s eager.

Island Story

Henry and Thomas are first friends who work hard and play like boys (the beggar’s cloak!). Then Henry makes Thomas archbishop, Thomas changes completely, and they quarrel about the Church. Henry’s angry words send four knights to Canterbury, and Thomas is killed in the cathedral. Marshall tells it plainly, and so can you. If she seems upset, stop at the break and finish Thursday. Ask her how Thomas changed.

Poem

“The Little Bird” is this week’s poem and copywork. A gay house-warming, and then a wee bird hops in: the poet as a new baby. Read it for delight; no lesson.

Betsy, sitting 1 (afternoon)

From the start of ch. 10 to the marked break before “Betsy stopped short.” Betsy goes to the Fair for her birthday with little Molly. Narrate briefly, or just enjoy it.

Tracy: treasure hunt, Bible as long as she’ll sit, hymn, poem and little-bird game. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray’s and copywork. Island Story is for Astoria only this week.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Bible · Exodus 34

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 34.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
New tablets; the LORD proclaims His name; Moses' face shines.

Our Island Story · Chapter 31 · Henry Plantagenet — The Story of Thomas à Becket

H. E. Marshall, An Island Story: A Child's History of England (New York: Frederick A. Stokes; printed in Edinburgh by T. and A. Constable), ch. XXXI, ***pp. 145–151*** *(optional break on p. 148). Same text as Our Island Story (London: T. C. & E. C. Jack, 1905). Public domain. Full chapter. · This packet: pp. 11–14*

King Henry was very fond of Thomas a Becket. They used to work very seriously, but when work was done they would play together like two boys.

The chancellor took care of the King's great seal, looked after the royal chapel, and had many other duties. He was a very important person, lived in splendid style, and dressed magnificently. In fact, his house and servants were richer and grander than those of the King. Many of the nobles sent their sons to serve in the chancellor's house, and the proudest were glad to wait on him and to try to please him.

Every day a great number of people dined with the chancellor. Sometimes the King would come in from riding, in the middle of dinner, jump over the table with a merry jest, and sit down among the guests.

Many stories are told of the fun the King and the chancellor used to have together. One day, while out riding, Thomas and King Henry met an old beggar, shivering and in rags.

'It would be a good action to give that poor man a coat,' said the King.

'It would indeed,' replied the chancellor.

'Then give him yours,' and the King laughingly seized the cloak which Thomas was wearing.

It was a beautiful new cloak of silk and fur, and Thomas did not wish to lose it. So he held it tight, while the King tugged hard to pull it off. Neither would let go until, between struggling and laughing, they both nearly fell off their horses.

The courtiers watched and laughed too, but at last the King succeeded in getting the cloak and flung it to the beggar. Thomas was not very pleased, but he had to make the best of it and go shivering for the rest of his ride. The poor beggar went away greatly delighted with the King's joke.

Once Henry sent Thomas with a message to the King of France. Thomas took so many soldiers and servants in glittering dress, so many horses and carriages with him, that the people came out of their houses to stare at him wherever he passed.

'Who is it?' every one asked.

'The Chancellor of England,' was the reply.

'Only the chancellor,' cried the astonished people. 'What must the King be, if the chancellor is so grand?'

Henry worked hard, and with the help of his chancellor improved many things in England. He found that the Church and the clergy, like everything else, had grown very unruly and disorderly. He determined to put them in order, and Thomas a Becket he thought would be the best man to help him. Thomas had been brought up as a priest, and King Henry resolved to make him Archbishop of Canterbury and head of all the clergy in England.

But Thomas was gay and worldly. He loved fine clothes and rich food. 'I do not want to be Archbishop of Canterbury,' he said to the King.

'You must be,' said the King.

'Then we shall quarrel,' said Thomas.

‘Why?’ said the King.

‘Because if you make me head of the Church I shall work for the Church and not for you. We shall no longer be friends, but enemies,’ replied Thomas.

But King Henry did not believe Thomas when he talked like this and, in spite of all he could say, he made him Archbishop of Canterbury.

As soon as he became archbishop, Thomas changed his way of living. He gave up his fine house and fine clothes and his great number of servants. He began to wear coarse, rough clothes, lived in a little narrow cell, ate very plain food and drank only water.

It is difficult to understand why he did this. Perhaps he thought that the Primate of all England, as the Archbishop of Canterbury is called, ought to be a very holy man, and he knew no other way of becoming holy, for in those days if a man fasted and went barefoot and wore coarse clothing it was thought that he must be a saint.

Thomas now wrote to the King and told him that he must find another chancellor, as he could not be archbishop and chancellor too. This was a great surprise and grief to the King. In those days it was nothing unusual for one man to be archbishop as well as chancellor. Henry had expected Thomas still to be chancellor and still to help him. He had only made him primate so that he should help him more.

But that was only the beginning of the troubles.

The Bishop of Rome, whom we call the Pope, said that he was the head of the whole Christian Church, and that no one could be made a bishop in England without his consent. Henry said that he, the King, was the head of the English church, and he would make what bishops he chose. Thomas, instead of siding with the King, sided with the Pope, so they quarrelled, as Thomas had warned Henry that they would.

In those days the clergy had grown very wicked. Instead of leading good lives, and being an example to others, they led bad lives. Priests and clergy who did wicked things were not judged by the same courts as other people. They were judged by a bishop’s court. Now a bishop’s court had no power to order any very severe punishment. If a priest killed a man, the worst that could happen to him would be that he would be beaten — not very hard — and have only bread and water to live on for a few days. Many wicked people became priests simply that they might be able to do as much wrong as they liked, without being punished for it.

Henry wished to put an end to this, so he said that all people who did wrong must be tried by the same judges, whether they were priests or not. But Thomas a Becket would not agree. Clergymen had always been judged by a bishop’s court, he said, and by a bishop’s court they should continue to be judged.

So the King and the primate quarrelled worse than ever, till the quarrel grew so fierce, and the King so angry, that Thomas fled over the sea to escape from him.

> **Optional break.** If she is tired or upset, stop here and finish Thursday (Stokes p. 148).

THE FOUR KNIGHTS

After a time Henry forgave Thomas and he came back to England, but almost at once he again began to quarrel with the King. This time Henry lost all patience and, in a burst of anger, he exclaimed, ‘Are there none of the idle people who eat my bread that will free me from this quarrelsome priest?’

Henry was angry, and did not really mean what he said. But four knights heard, and thinking to please their king they took ship (for Henry was in Normandy at this time), crossed the sea to England, and rode to Canterbury. Arrived there they went to the archbishop’s house. They found him almost alone. With angry words they told him that he must either promise not to quarrel with Henry or he must leave England.

‘I shall do what I think is right,’ replied Thomas. ‘If the King tells me to do things which I think are wrong, I will not obey him. I am the servant of God. God is higher than the King; I shall obey Him.’

This answer enraged the knights, and more angry words were spoken. Then they went away, telling Thomas to beware, for they would come again.

‘You will find me here,’ replied Thomas proudly. ‘Never again will I forsake my people.’

All the archbishop’s friends, and the monks and priests who lived with him, were very much afraid. They felt sure that these angry knights meant to do something dreadful. They begged Thomas to leave his house and take refuge in the cathedral, but he would not. ‘I said they would find me here,’ he replied to all entreaties.

The day passed. The time for evening service came. Then only did Thomas consent to leave his house and go into the cathedral, for, said he, ‘It is my duty to lead the service.’ The priests tried to hurry him, they tried to drag him along quickly, but Thomas would not hasten. He walked slowly and solemnly, having the great cross carried before him as usual. He feared no man.

When at last he was safe within the cathedral, the priests wished to lock and bar the doors. But Thomas forbade them. ‘This is not a fortress but the House of God, into which every one is free to enter. I forbid you to bar the doors,’ he said.

The priests were in despair. They loved their archbishop, they knew that he was in danger, but he would not try to save himself.

Even as he spoke there was a great noise without. The door burst open, and the four knights, dressed in complete armour and carrying drawn swords in their hands, rushed into the cathedral.

The frightened people fled in all directions. The archbishop was left almost alone. Only three remained with him — his cross-bearer and two other faithful friends.

In the dim twilight which filled the cathedral it would have been easy for Thomas to escape. But he would not go. ‘I told them that they should find me here,’ he said again to the monks who tried to drag him away.

Even as it was, the knights could not find him. In the gathering darkness they clanked and clanged through the great church, seeking him.

‘Where is the traitor?’ called one of them.

No one answered. Only the word ‘traitor’ echoed again through the silence.

‘Where is the archbishop?’ he called again.

‘I am here,’ answered the voice of Thomas a Becket out of the darkness. ‘I am here; no traitor, but a servant of God. What do you want?’

They stood before him, four armed knights against one unarmed priest. Yet he was not afraid.

‘Will you be at peace with the King?’ asked the knights.

‘What I have done I shall continue to do,’ replied Thomas.

‘Then die.’

The knights seized him and tried to drag him out of the cathedral, for they feared to kill him in a holy place.

But Thomas would not go. He held tightly to a pillar. His cross-bearer, still holding the cross, threw one arm round the archbishop, trying to protect him.

The knight who had first spoken struck at Thomas. The cross-bearer received the blow upon his arm, which fell to his side broken. The next stroke fell on Thomas a Becket’s defenceless head.

In a few minutes all was over.

‘In the name of Christ, and for the defence of the Church, I die willingly,’ said Thomas, and spoke no more.

Then the knights, fearful of what they had done, fled, leaving the dead archbishop alone in the dark, silent cathedral.

End of chapter. Narrate. Week 12: ch. 32, Henry Plantagenet — The Story of the Conquest of Ireland.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

The Little Bird

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes (London: Constable; 1924 printing), ***p. 18****. Text: Project Gutenberg #3753 (1913). Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here. · This packet: p. 15*

My dear Daddie bought a mansion
For to bring my Mammie to,
In a hat with a long feather,
And a trailing gown of blue;
And a company of fiddlers
And a rout of maids and men
Danced the clock round to the morning,
In a gay house-warming then.
And when all the guests were gone, and
All was still as still can be,
In from the dark ivy hopped a
Wee small bird: and that was Me.

> **Copywork:** In from the dark ivy hopped a / Wee small bird: and that was Me.

Understood Betsy · Chapter 10 · Betsy Has a Birthday

Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy (New York: Henry Holt, 1917), ch. X, ***pp. 201–233*** *(sitting 2 begins p. 210, sitting 3 p. 221). Text: Project Gutenberg #5347. Public domain. Full chapter, in three sittings. · This packet: pp. 16–23*

Betsy's birthday was the ninth day of September, and the Necronsett Valley Fair is always held from the eighth to the twelfth. So it was decided that Betsy should celebrate her birthday by going up to Woodford, where the Fair was held. The Putneys weren't going that year, but the people on the next farm, the Wendells, said they could make room in their surrey for the two little girls; for, of course, Molly was going, too. In fact, she said the Fair was held partly to celebrate her being six years old. This would happen on the seventeenth of October. Molly insisted that that was PLENTY close enough to the ninth of September to be celebrated then. This made Betsy feel like laughing out, but observing that the Putneys only looked at each other with the faintest possible quirk in the corners of their serious mouths, she understood that they were afraid that Molly's feelings might be hurt if they laughed out loud. So Betsy tried to curve her young lips to the same kind and secret mirth.

And, I can't tell you why, this effort not to hurt Molly's feelings made her have a perfect spasm of love for Molly. She threw herself on her and gave her a great hug that tipped them both over on the couch on top of Shep, who stopped snoring with his great gurgling snort, wriggled out from under them, and stood with laughing eyes and wagging tail, looking at them as they rolled and giggled among the pillows.

"What dress are you going to wear to the Fair, Betsy?" asked Cousin Ann. "And we must decide about Molly's, too."

This stopped their rough-and-tumble fun in short order, and they applied themselves to the serious question of a toilet.

When the great day arrived and the surrey drove away from the Wendells' gate, Betsy was in a fresh pink-and-white gingham which she had helped Cousin Ann make, and plump Molly looked like something good to eat in a crisp white little dimity, one of Betsy's old dresses, with a deep hem taken in to make it short enough for the little butter-ball. Because it was Betsy's birthday, she sat on the front seat with Mr. Wendell, and part of the time, when there were not too many teams on the road, she drove, herself. Mrs. Wendell and her sister filled the back seat solidly full from side to side and made one continuous soft lap on which Molly happily perched, her eyes shining, her round cheeks red with joyful excitement. Betsy looked back at her several times and thought how very nice Molly looked. She had, of course, little idea how she herself looked, because the mirrors at Putney Farm were all small and high up, and anyhow they were so old and greenish that they made everybody look very queer-colored. You looked in them to see if your hair was smooth, and that was about all you could stand.

So it was a great surprise to Betsy later in the morning, as she and Molly wandered hand in hand through the wonders of Industrial Hall, to catch sight of Molly in a full-length mirror as clear as water. She was almost startled to see how faithfully reflected were the yellow of the little girl's curls, the clear pink and white of her face, and the blue of her soft eyes. An older girl was reflected there also, near Molly, a dark-eyed, red-cheeked, sturdy little girl, standing very straight on two strong legs, holding her head high and free, her dark eyes looking out brightly from her tanned face. For an instant Betsy gazed into those clear eyes and then ... why, gracious goodness! That was herself she was looking at! How changed she was! How very, very different she looked from the last time she had seen herself in a big mirror! She remembered it well—out shopping with Aunt Frances in a department store, she had caught sight of a pale little girl, with a thin neck, and spindling legs half-hidden in the folds of Aunt Frances's skirts. But she didn't look even like the sister of this browned, muscular, upstanding child who held Molly's hand so firmly.

All this came into her mind and went out again in a moment, for Molly caught sight of a big doll in the next aisle and they hurried over to inspect her clothing. The mirror was forgotten in the many exciting sights and sounds and smells of their first county fair.

The two little girls were to wander about as they pleased until noon, when they were to meet the Wendells in the shadow of Industrial Hall and eat their picnic lunch together. The two parties arrived together from different directions, having seen very different sides of the Fair. The children were full of the merry-go-rounds, the balloon-seller, the toy-venders, and the pop-corn stands, while the Wendells exchanged views on the shortness of a hog's legs, the dip in a cow's back, and the thickness of a sheep's wool. The Wendells, it seemed, had met some cousins they didn't expect to see, who, not knowing about Betsy and Molly, had hoped that they might ride home with the Wendells.

"Don't you suppose," Mrs. Wendell asked Betsy, "that you and Molly could go home with the Vaughans? They're here in their big wagon. You could sit on the floor with the Vaughan children."

Betsy and Molly thought this would be great fun, and agreed enthusiastically.

"All right then," said Mrs. Wendell. She called to a young man who stood inside the building, near an open window: "Oh, Frank, Will Vaughan is going to be in your booth this afternoon, isn't he?"

"Yes, ma'am," said the young man. "His turn is from two to four."

"Well, you tell him, will you, that the two little girls who live at Putney Farm are going to go home with them. They can sit on the bottom of the wagon with the Vaughan young ones."

"Yes, ma'am," said the young man, with a noticeable lack of interest in how Betsy and Molly got home.

"Now, Betsy," said Mrs. Wendell, "you go round to that booth at two and ask Will Vaughan what time they're going to start and where their wagon is, and then you be sure not to keep them waiting a minute."

"No, I won't," said Betsy. "I'll be sure to be there on time."

She and Molly still had twenty cents to spend out of the forty they had brought with them, twenty-five earned by berry-picking and fifteen a present from Uncle Henry. They now put their heads together to see how they could make the best possible use of their four nickels. Cousin Ann had put no restrictions whatever on them, saying they could buy any sort of truck or rubbish they could find, except the pink lemonade. She said she had been told the venders washed their glasses in that, and their hands, and for all she knew their faces. Betsy was for merry-go-rounds, but Molly yearned for a big red balloon; and while they were buying that a man came by with toy dogs, little brown dogs with curled-wire tails. He called out that they would bark when you pulled their tails, and seeing the little girls looking at him he pulled the tail of the one he held. It gave forth a fine loud yelp, just like Shep when his tail got stepped on. Betsy bought one, all done up neatly in a box tied with blue string. She thought it a great bargain to get a dog who would bark for five cents. (Later on, when they undid the string and opened the box, they found the dog had one leg broken off and wouldn't make the faintest squeak when his tail was pulled; but that is the sort of thing you must expect to have happen to you at a county fair.)

Now they had ten cents left and they decided to have a ride apiece on the merry-go-round. But, glancing up at the clock-face in the tower over Agricultural Hall, Betsy noticed it was half-past two and she decided to go first to the booth where Will Vaughan was to be and find out what time they would start for home. She found the booth with no difficulty, but William Vaughan was not in it. Nor was the young man she had seen before. There was a new one, a strange one, a careless, whistling young man, with very bright socks, very yellow shoes, and very striped cuffs. He said, in answer to Betsy's inquiry: "Vaughan? Will Vaughan? Never heard the name," and immediately went on whistling and looking up and down the aisle over the heads of the little girls, who stood gazing up at him with very wide, startled eyes. An older man leaned over from the next booth and said: "Will Vaughan? He from Hillsboro? Well, I heard somebody say those Hillsboro Vaughans had word one of their cows was awful sick, and they had to start right home that minute."

Betsy came to herself out of her momentary daze and snatched Molly's hand. "Hurry! quick! We must find the Wendells before they get away!" In her agitation (for she was really very much frightened) she forgot how easily terrified little Molly was. Her alarm instantly sent the child into a panic. "Oh, Betsy! Betsy! What will we do!" she gasped, as Betsy pulled her along the aisle and out of the door.

“Oh, the Wendells can’t be gone yet,” said Betsy reassuringly, though she was not at all sure she was telling the truth. She ran as fast as she could drag Molly’s fat legs, to the horse-shed where Mr. Wendell had tied his horses and left the surrey. The horse-shed was empty, quite empty.

> **Stop here on Wednesday.** Narrate. Friday afternoon picks up at Holt p. 210.

FRIDAY AFTERNOON · SECOND SITTING

Betsy stopped short and stood still, her heart seeming to be up in her throat so that she could hardly breathe. After all, she was only ten that day, you must remember. Molly began to cry loudly, hiding her weeping face in Betsy’s dress. “What will we do, Betsy! What can we DO!” she wailed.

Betsy did not answer. She did not know what they WOULD do! They were eight miles from Putney Farm, far too much for Molly to walk, and anyhow neither of them knew the way. They had only ten cents left, and nothing to eat. And the only people they knew in all that throng of strangers had gone back to Hillsboro.

“What will we do, Betsy?” Molly kept on crying out, horrified by Betsy’s silence and evident consternation.

The other child’s head swam. She tried again the formula which had helped her when Molly fell into the Wolf Pit, and asked herself, desperately, “What would Cousin Ann do if she were here!” But that did not help her much now, because she could not possibly imagine what Cousin Ann would do under such appalling circumstances. Yes, one thing Cousin Ann would be sure to do, of course; she would quiet Molly first of all.

At this thought Betsy sat down on the ground and took the panic-stricken little girl into her lap, wiping away the tears and saying, stoutly, “Now, Molly, stop crying this minute. I’ll take care of you, of course. I’ll get you home all right.”

“How’ll you ever do it?” sobbed Molly.

“Everybody’s gone and left us. We can’t walk!”

“Never you mind how,” said Betsy, trying to be facetious and mock-mysterious, though her own under lip was quivering a little. “That’s my surprise party for you. Just you wait. Now come on back to that booth. Maybe Will Vaughan didn’t go home with his folks.”

She had very little hope of this, and only went back there because it seemed to her a little less dauntingly strange than every other spot in the howling wilderness about her; for all at once the Fair, which had seemed so lively and cheerful and gay before, seemed now a horrible, frightening, noisy place, full of hurried strangers who came and went their own ways, with not a glance out of their hard eyes for two little girls stranded far from home.

The bright-colored young man was no better when they found him again. He stopped his whistling only long enough to say, “Nope, no Will Vaughan anywhere around these diggings yet.”

“We were going home with the Vaughans,” murmured Betsy, in a low tone, hoping for some help from him.

“Looks as though you’d better go home on the cars,” advised the young man casually. He smoothed his black hair back straighter than ever from his forehead and looked over their heads.

“How much does it cost to go to Hillsboro on the cars?” asked Betsy with a sinking heart.

“You’ll have to ask somebody else about that,” said the young man. “What I don’t know about this Rube state! I never was in it before.” He spoke as though he were very proud of the fact.

Betsy turned and went over to the older man who had told them about the Vaughans.

Molly trotted at her heels, quite comforted, now that Betsy was talking so competently to grown-ups. She did not hear what they said, nor try to. Now that Betsy’s voice sounded all right she had no more fears. Betsy would manage somehow. She heard Betsy’s voice again talking to the other man, but she was busy looking at an exhibit of beautiful jelly glasses, and paid no attention. Then Betsy led her away again out of doors, where everybody was walking back and forth under the bright September sky, blowing on horns, waving plumes of brilliant tissue-paper, tickling each other with peacock feathers, and eating pop-corn and candy out of paper bags.

That reminded Molly that they had ten cents yet. “Oh, Betsy,” she proposed, “let’s take a nickel of our money for some pop-corn.”

She was startled by Betsy’s fierce sudden clutch at their little purse and by the quaver in her voice as she answered: “No, no, Molly. We’ve got to save every cent of that. I’ve found out it costs thirty cents for us both to go home to Hillsboro on the train. The last one goes at six o’clock.”

“We haven’t got but ten,” said Molly.

Betsy looked at her silently for a moment and then burst out, “I’ll earn the rest! I’ll earn it somehow! I’ll have to! There isn’t any other way!”

“All right,” said Molly quaintly, not seeing anything unusual in this. “You can, if you want to. I’ll wait for you here.”

“No, you won’t!” cried Betsy, who had quite enough of trying to meet people in a crowd. “No, you won’t! You just follow me every minute! I don’t want you out of my sight!”

They began to move forward now, Betsy’s eyes wildly roving from one place to another. How COULD a little girl earn money at a county fair! She was horribly afraid to go up and speak to a stranger, and yet how else could she begin?

“Here, Molly, you wait here,” she said. “Don’t you budge till I come back.”

But alas! Molly had only a moment to wait that time, for the man who was selling lemonade answered Betsy’s shy question with a stare and a curt, “Lord, no! What could a young one like you do for me?”

The little girls wandered on, Molly calm and expectant, confident in Betsy; Betsy with a very dry mouth and a very gone feeling. They were passing by a big shed-like building now, where a large sign proclaimed that the Woodford Ladies’ Aid Society would serve a hot chicken dinner for thirty-five cents. Of course the sign was not accurate, for at half-past three, almost four, the chicken dinner had long ago been all eaten and in place of the diners was a group of weary women moving languidly about or standing saggingly by a great table piled with dirty dishes. Betsy paused here, meditated a moment, and went in rapidly so that her courage would not evaporate.

The woman with gray hair looked down at her a little impatiently and said, “Dinner’s all over.”

“I didn’t come for dinner,” said Betsy, swallowing hard. “I came to see if you wouldn’t hire me to wash your dishes. I’ll do them for twenty-five cents.”

The woman laughed, looked from little Betsy to the great pile of dishes, and said, turning away, “Mercy, child, if you washed from now till morning, you wouldn’t make a hole in what we’ve got to do.”

Betsy heard her say to the other women, “Some young one wanting more money for the side-shows.”

Now, now was the moment to remember what Cousin Ann would have done. She would certainly not have shaken all over with hurt feelings nor have allowed the tears to come stingingly to her eyes. So Betsy sternly made herself stop doing these things. And Cousin Ann wouldn’t have given way to the dreadful sinking feeling of utter discouragement, but would have gone right on to the next place. So, although Betsy felt like nothing so much as crooking her elbow over her face and crying as hard as she could cry, she stiffened her back, took Molly’s hand again, and stepped out, heart-sick within but very steady (although rather pale) without.

She and Molly walked along in the crowd again, Molly laughing and pointing out the pranks and antics of the young people, who were feeling livelier than ever as the afternoon wore on. Betsy looked at them grimly with unseeing eyes. It was four o’clock. The last train for Hillsboro left in two hours and she was no nearer having the price of the tickets. She stopped for a moment to get her breath; for, although they were walking slowly, she kept feeling breathless and choked. It occurred to her that if ever a little girl had had a more horrible birthday she never heard of one!

“Oh, I wish I could, Dan!” said a young voice near her. “But honest! Momma’d just eat me up alive if I left the booth for a minute!”

Betsy turned quickly. A very pretty girl with yellow hair and blue eyes (she looked as Molly might when she was grown-up) was leaning over the edge of a little canvas-covered booth, the sign of which announced that home-made doughnuts and soft drinks were for sale there. A young man, very flushed and gay, was pulling at the girl's blue gingham sleeve. "Oh, come on, Annie. Just one turn! The floor's elegant. You can keep an eye on the booth from the hall! Nobody's going to run away with the old thing anyhow!"

"Honest, I'd love to! But I got a great lot of dishes to wash, too! You know Momma!" She looked longingly toward the open-air dancing floor, out from which just then floated a burst of brazen music.

"Oh, PLEASE!" said a small voice. "I'll do it for twenty cents."

Betsy stood by the girl's elbow, all quivering earnestness.

"Do what, kiddie?" asked the girl in a good-natured surprise.

"Everything!" said Betsy, compendiously. "Everything! Wash the dishes, tend the booth; YOU can go dance! I'll do it for twenty cents."

The eyes of the girl and the man met in high amusement. "My! Aren't we up and coming!" said the man. "You're most as big as a pint-cup, aren't you?" he said to Betsy.

The little girl flushed—she detested being laughed at—but she looked straight into the laughing eyes. "I'm ten years old today," she said, "and I can wash dishes as well as anybody." She spoke with dignity.

The young man burst out into a great laugh.

"Great kid, what!" he said to the girl, and then, "Say, Annie, why not? Your mother won't be here for an hour. The kid can keep folks from walking off with the dope and ..."

"I'll do the dishes, too," repeated Betsy, trying hard not to mind being laughed at, and keeping her eyes fixed steadily on the tickets to Hillsboro.

"Well, by gosh," said the young man, laughing. "Here's our chance, Annie, for fair! Come along!"

The girl laughed, too, out of high spirits. "Wouldn't Momma be crazy!" she said hilariously. "But she'll never know. Here, you cute kid, here's my apron." She took off her long apron and tied it around Betsy's neck. "There's the soap, there's the table. You stack the dishes up on that counter."

She was out of the little gate in the counter in a twinkling, just as Molly, in answer to a beckoning gesture from Betsy, came in. "Hello, there's another one!" said the gay young man, gayer and gayer. "Hello, button! What you going to do? I suppose when they try to crack the safe you'll run at them and bark and drive them away!"

Molly opened her sweet, blue eyes very wide, not understanding a single word. The girl laughed, swooped back, gave Molly a kiss, and disappeared, running side by side with the young man toward the dance hall.

> **Stop here on Friday.** Saturday morning picks up at Holt p. 221.

SATURDAY · THIRD SITTING

Betsy mounted on a soap box and began joyfully to wash the dishes. She had never thought that ever in her life would she simply LOVE to wash dishes beyond anything else! But it was so. Her relief was so great that she could have kissed the coarse, thick plates and glasses as she washed them.

"It's all right, Molly; it's all right!" she quavered exultantly to Molly over her shoulder. But as Molly had not (from the moment Betsy took command) suspected that it was not all right, she only nodded and asked if she might sit up on a barrel where she could watch the crowd go by.

"I guess you could. I don't know why NOT," said Betsy doubtfully. She lifted her up and went back to her dishes. Never were dishes washed better!

"Two doughnuts, please," said a man's voice behind her.

Oh, mercy, there was somebody come to buy! Whatever should she do? She came forward intending to say that the owner of the booth was away and she didn't know anything about ... but the man laid down a nickel, took two doughnuts, and turned away. Betsy gasped and looked at the home-made sign stuck into the big pan of doughnuts. Sure enough, it read "2 for 5." She put the nickel up on a shelf and went back to her dishwashing. Selling things wasn't so hard, she reflected.

As her hunted feeling of desperation relaxed she began to find some fun in her new situation, and when a woman with two little boys approached she came forward to wait on her, elated, important. "Two for five," she said in a businesslike tone. The woman put down a dime, took up four doughnuts, divided them between her sons, and departed.

[Illustration: Never were dishes washed better!]

"My!" said Molly, looking admiringly at Betsy's coolness over this transaction. Betsy went back to her dishes, stepping high.

"Oh, Betsy, see! The pig! The big ox!" cried Molly now, looking from her coign of vantage down the wide, grass-grown lane between the booths.

Betsy craned her head around over her shoulder, continuing conscientiously to wash and wipe the dishes. The prize stock was being paraded around the Fair; the great prize ox, his shining horns tipped with blue rosettes; the prize cows, with wreaths around their necks; the prize horses, four or five of them as glossy as satin, curving their bright, strong necks and stepping as though on eggs, their manes and tails braided with bright ribbon; and then, "Oh, Betsy, LOOK at the pig!" screamed Molly again—the smaller animals, the sheep, the calves, the colts, and the pig, which waddled along with portly dignity.

Betsy looked as well as she could over her shoulder ... and in years to come she can shut her eyes and see again in every detail that rustic procession under the golden, September light.

But she looked anxiously at the clock. It was nearing five. Oh, suppose the girl forgot and danced too long!

"Two bottles of ginger ale and half a dozen doughnuts," said a man with a woman and three children.

Betsy looked feverishly among the bottles ranged on the counter, selected two marked ginger ale, and glared at their corrugated tin stoppers. How DID you get them open?

"Here's your opener," said the man, "if that's what you're looking for. Here, you get the glasses and I'll open the bottles. We're in kind of a hurry. Got to catch a train."

Well, they were not the only people who had to catch a train, Betsy thought sadly. They drank in gulps and departed, cramming doughnuts into their mouths. Betsy wished ardently that the girl would come back. She was now almost sure that she had forgotten and would dance there till nightfall. But there, there she came, running along, as light-footed after an hour's dancing as when she had left the booth.

"Here you are, kid," said the young man, producing a quarter. "We've had the time of our young lives, thanks to you."

Betsy gave him back one of the nickels that remained to her, but he refused it.

"No, keep the change," he said royally. "It was worth it."

"Then I'll buy two doughnuts with my extra nickel," said Betsy.

"No, you won't," said the girl. "You'll take all you want for nothing ... Momma'll never miss 'em. And what you sell here has got to be fresh every day. Here, hold out your hands, both of you."

"Some people came and bought things," said Betsy, happening to remember as she and Molly turned away. "The money is on that shelf."

“Well, NOW!” said the girl, “if she didn’t take hold and sell things! Say ...”—she ran after Betsy and gave her a hug —“you smart young one, I wish’t I had a little sister just like you!”

Molly and Betsy hurried along out of the gate into the main street of the town and down to the station. Molly was eating doughnuts as she went. They were both quite hungry by this time, but Betsy could not think of eating till she had those tickets in her hand.

She pushed her quarter and a nickel into the ticket-seller’s window and said “Hillsboro” in as confident a tone as she could; but when the precious bits of paper were pushed out at her and she actually held them, her knees shook under her and she had to go and sit down on the bench.

“My! Aren’t these doughnuts good?” said Molly. “I never in my life had ENOUGH doughnuts before!”

Betsy drew a long breath and began rather languidly to eat one herself; she felt, all of a sudden, very, very tired.

She was tireder still when they got out of the train at Hillsboro Station and started wearily up the road toward Putney Farm. Two miles lay before them, two miles which they had often walked before, but never after such a day as now lay back of them. Molly dragged her feet as she walked and hung heavily on Betsy’s hand. Betsy plodded along, her head hanging, her eyes all gritty with fatigue and sleepiness. A light buggy spun round the turn of the road behind them, the single horse trotting fast as though the driver were in a hurry, the wheels rattling smartly on the hard road. The little girls drew out to one side and stood waiting till the road should be free again. When he saw them the driver pulled the horse back so quickly it stood almost straight up. He peered at them through the twilight and then with a loud shout sprang over the side of the buggy.

It was Uncle Henry—oh, goody, it was Uncle Henry come to meet them! They wouldn’t have to walk any further!

But what was the matter with Uncle Henry? He ran up to them, exclaiming, “Are ye all right? Are ye all right?” He stooped over and felt of them desperately as though he expected them to be broken somewhere. And Betsy could feel that his old hands were shaking, that he was trembling all over. When she said, “Why, yes, Uncle Henry, we’re all right. We came home on the cars,” Uncle Henry leaned up against the fence as though he couldn’t stand up. He took off his hat and wiped his forehead and he said—it didn’t seem as though it could be Uncle Henry talking, he sounded so excited—“Well, well—well, by gosh! My! Well, by thunder! Now! And so here ye are! And you’re all right! WELL!”

He couldn’t seem to stop exclaiming, and you can’t imagine anything stranger than an Uncle Henry who couldn’t stop exclaiming.

After they all got into the buggy he quieted down a little and said, “Thunderation! But we’ve had a scare! When the Wendells come back with their cousins early this afternoon, they said you were coming with the Vaughans. And then when you didn’t come and DIDN’T come, we telephoned to the Vaughans, and they said they hadn’t seen hide nor hair of ye, and didn’t even know you were TO the Fair at all! I tell you, your Aunt Abigail and I had an awful turn! Ann and I hitched up quicker’n scat and she put right out with Prince up toward Woodford and I took Jessie down this way; thought maybe I’d get trace of ye somewhere here. Well, land!” He wiped his forehead again. “Wa’n’t I glad to see you standin’ there ... get along, Jess! I want to get the news to Abigail soon as I can!”

“Now tell me what in thunder DID happen to you!”

Betsy began at the beginning and told straight through, interrupted at first by indignant comments from Uncle Henry, who was outraged by the Wendells’ loose wearing of their responsibility for the children. But as she went on he quieted down to a closely attentive silence, interrupting only to keep Jess at her top speed.

Now that it was all safely over, Betsy thought her story quite an interesting one, and she omitted no detail, although she wondered once or twice if perhaps Uncle Henry were listening to her, he kept so still. “And so I bought the tickets and we got home,” she ended, adding, “Oh, Uncle Henry, you ought to have seen the prize pig! He was TOO funny!”

They turned into the Putney yard now and saw Aunt Abigail’s bulky form on the porch.

“Got ’em, Abby! All right! No harm done!” shouted Uncle Henry.

Aunt Abigail turned without a word and went back into the house. When the little girls dragged their weary legs in they found her quietly setting out some supper for them on the table, but she was wiping away with her apron the joyful tears which ran down her cheeks, such white cheeks! It seemed so strange to see rosy Aunt Abigail with a face like paper.

“Well, I’m glad to see ye,” she told them soberly. “Sit right down and have some hot milk. I had some all ready.”

The telephone rang, she went into the next room, and they heard her saying, in an unsteady voice: “All right, Ann. They’re here. Your father just brought them in. I haven’t had time to hear about what happened yet. But they’re all right. You’d better come home.”

“That’s your Cousin Ann telephoning from the Marshalls’.”

She herself went and sat down heavily, and when Uncle Henry came in a few minutes later she asked him in a rather weak voice for the ammonia bottle. He rushed for it, got her a fan and a drink of cold water, and hung over her anxiously till the color began to come back into her pale face. “I know just how you feel, Mother,” he said sympathetically. “When I saw ’em standin’ there by the roadside I felt as though somebody had hit me a clip right in the pit of the stomach.”

The little girls ate their supper in a tired daze, not paying any attention to what the grown-ups were saying, until rapid hoofs clicked on the stones outside and Cousin Ann came in quickly, her black eyes snapping.

“Now, for mercy’s sake, tell me what happened,” she said, adding hotly, “and if I don’t give that Maria Wendell a piece of my mind!”

Uncle Henry broke in: “*I*’M going to tell what happened. I WANT to do it. You and Mother just listen, just sit right down and listen.” His voice was shaking with feeling, and as he went on and told of Betsy’s afternoon, her fright, her confusion, her forming the plan of coming home on the train and of earning the money for the tickets, he made, for once, no Putney pretense of casual coolness. His old eyes flashed fire as he talked.

Betsy, watching him, felt her heart swell and beat fast in incredulous joy. Why, he was proud of her! She had done something to make the Putney cousins proud of her!

When Uncle Henry came to the part where she went on asking for employment after one and then another refusal, Cousin Ann reached out her long arms and quickly, almost roughly, gathered Betsy up on her lap, holding her close as she listened. Betsy had never before sat on Cousin Ann’s lap.

And when Uncle Henry finished—he had not forgotten a single thing Betsy had told him—and asked, “What do you think of THAT for a little girl ten years old today?” Cousin Ann opened the flood-gates wide and burst out, “I think I never heard of a child’s doing a smarter, grittier thing ... AND I DON’T CARE IF SHE DOES HEAR ME SAY SO!”

It was a great, a momentous, an historic moment!

Betsy, enthroned on those strong knees, wondered if any little girl had ever had such a beautiful birthday.

> **End of chapter 10.** Week 12: chapter 11, “Understood Aunt Frances.”

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · Ray's (Lesson 34) · *The Little Duke* ch. 6 first half (printed, sitting 1) · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 9) · Harvey's · folk song recording · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Porch or backyard, twenty minutes. Frost or dew? Count the birds in the yaupon.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 35:1–36:7**

The people bring gifts for the tabernacle until Moses says "enough." Read once, narrate, stop. (36:8–38 optional.)

8:40 **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Then put it away.

8:55 **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier," with the clearer sing-along recording (shelf page). One verse.

9:05 **Ray's · Lesson 34**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy nearby with McGuffey.

9:25 **Tales · Little Duke ch. 6a, sitting 1**

Printed. Leaving Rouen and the long road into France. Stop at the marked break (~8 min). Narrate.

9:45 **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 9**

From your copy, ~15–20 min. Narrate. Do not jump ahead to AO's ch. 16.

10:10 **Harvey's · short sitting**

About ten minutes, next lesson, oral and light. Then stop.

How to teach Thursday

> **Little Duke, first sitting.** Tree in the Trail from your copy. Harvey's first sitting. Finish Island Story here if you stopped at the break Wednesday.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 35:1–36:7. Moses asks for gifts from everyone whose heart is willing: gold, yarn, skins, wood, spices, stones. Men and women bring so much, and the skilled workers Bezalel and Oholiab make so much, that Moses has to tell the people to stop giving. The rest of ch. 36 describes the building. Read it later or skip it. Awana after.

Little Duke

Richard rides away from Rouen beside the King, who makes much of him. Then the country changes: a dark forest, a castle where the baron is cool to him, a morass, a dreary heath, wastes and marshes. Stop at the marked break. Ask her what Richard noticed that was different from Normandy.

Tree in the Trail

Chapter 9, from your physical book. One sitting. Find the place on the trail map if your copy has one. Never reprint.

Harvey's

First of two short sittings. Oral. Next lesson from your place.

Tracy: nature, Bible, folk song. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's. She may listen to Little Duke if she is content.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

Bible · Exodus 35:1–36:7

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 35:1–36:7.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Willing gifts for the tabernacle — more than enough. 36:8–38 optional. Awana follows.

READ THIS · THURSDAY + FRIDAY

The Little Duke · Chapter 6 · first half

Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke (London & New York: Macmillan), ch. VI, first half, ***pp. 102–114*** *(Macmillan printing scanned at the Internet Archive; the second sitting begins on p. 108). Text: Project Gutenberg #3048, from the 1905 Macmillan edition. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 27–29*

Away from the tall narrow gateway of Rollo's Tower, with the cluster of friendly, sorrowful faces looking forth from it, away from the booth-like shops of Rouen, and the stout burghers shouting with all the power of their lungs, "Long live Duke Richard! Long live King Louis! Death to the Fleming!"—away from the broad Seine—away from home and friends, rode the young Duke of Normandy, by the side of the palfrey of the King of France.

The King took much notice of him, kept him by his side, talked to him, admired the beautiful cattle grazing in security in the green pastures, and, as he looked at the rich dark brown earth of the fields, the Castles towering above the woods, the Convents looking like great farms, the many villages round the rude Churches, and the numerous population who came out to gaze at the party, and repeat the cry of "Long live the King! Blessings on the little Duke!" he told Richard, again and again, that his was the most goodly duchy in France and Germany to boot.

When they crossed the Epte, the King would have Richard in the same boat with him, and sitting close to Louis, and talking eagerly about falcons and hounds, the little Duke passed the boundary of his own dukedom.

The country beyond was not like Normandy. First they came to a great forest, which seemed to have no path through it. The King ordered that one of the men, who had rowed them across, should be made to serve as guide, and two of the men-at-arms took him between them, and forced him to lead the way, while others, with their swords and battle-axes, cut down and cleared away the tangled branches and briars that nearly choked the path. All the time, every one was sharply on the look-out for robbers, and the weapons were all held ready for use at a moment's notice. On getting beyond the forest a Castle rose before them, and, though it was not yet late in the day, they resolved to rest there, as a marsh lay not far before them, which it would not have been safe to traverse in the evening twilight.

The Baron of the Castle received them with great respect to the King, but without paying much attention to the Duke of Normandy, and Richard did not find the second place left for him at the board. He coloured violently, and looked first at the King, and then at Osmond, but Osmond held up his finger in warning; he remembered how he had lost his temper before, and what had come of it, and resolved to try to bear it better; and just then the Baron's daughter, a gentle-looking maiden of fifteen or sixteen, came and spoke to him, and entertained him so well, that he did not think much more of his offended dignity.—When they set off on their journey again, the Baron and several of his followers came with them to show the only safe way across the morass, and a very slippery, treacherous, quaking road it was, where the horses' feet left pools of water wherever they trod. The King and the Baron rode together, and the other French Nobles closed round them; Richard was left quite in the background, and though the French men-at-arms took care not to lose sight of him, no one offered him any assistance, excepting Osmond, who, giving his own horse to Sybald, one of the two Norman grooms who accompanied him, led Richard's horse by the bridle along the whole distance of the marshy path, a business that could scarcely have been pleasant, as Osmond wore his heavy hauberk, and his pointed, iron-guarded boots sunk deep at every step into the bog. He spoke little, but seemed to be taking good heed of every stump of willow or stepping-stone that might serve as a note of remembrance of the path.

At the other end of the morass began a long tract of dreary-looking, heathy waste, without a sign of life. The Baron took leave of the King, only sending three men-at-arms, to show him the way to a monastery, which was to be the next halting-place. He sent three, because it was not safe for one, even fully armed, to ride alone, for fear of the attacks of the followers of a certain marauding Baron, who was at deadly feud with him, and made all that border a most perilous region. Richard might well observe that he did not like the Vexin half as well as Normandy, and that the people ought to learn Fru Astrida's story of the golden bracelets, which, in his grandfather's time, had hung untouched for a year, in a tree in a forest.

It was pretty much the same through the whole journey, waste lands, marshes, and forests alternated. The Castles stood on high mounds frowning on the country round, and villages were clustered round them, where the people either fled away, driving off their cattle with them at the first sight of an armed band, or else, if they remained, proved to be thin, wretched-looking creatures, with wasted limbs, aguish faces, and often iron collars round their necks. Wherever there was anything of more prosperous appearance, such as a few cornfields, vineyards on the slopes of the hills, fat cattle, and peasantry looking healthy and secure, there was sure to be seen a range of long low stone buildings, surmounted with crosses, with a short square Church tower rising in the midst, and interspersed with gnarled hoary old apple-trees, or with gardens of pot-herbs spreading before them to the meadows. If, instead of two or three men-at-arms from a Castle, or of some trembling serf pressed into the service, and beaten, threatened, and watched to prevent treachery, the King asked for a guide at a Convent, some lay brother would take his staff; or else mount an ass, and proceed in perfect confidence and security as to his return homewards, sure that his poverty and his sacred character would alike protect him from any outrage from the most lawless marauder of the neighbourhood.

> **Stop here on Thursday.** Narrate. Friday picks up at Laon (Macmillan p. 108).

FRIDAY · SECOND SITTING

Thus they travelled until they reached the royal Castle of Laon, where the Fleur-de-Lys standard on the battlements announced the presence of Gerberge, Queen of France, and her two sons. The King rode first into the court with his Nobles, and before Richard could follow him through the narrow arched gateway, he had dismounted, entered the Castle, and was out of sight. Osmond held the Duke's stirrup, and followed him up the steps which led to the Castle Hall. It was full of people, but no one made way, and Richard, holding his Squire's hand, looked up in his face, inquiring and bewildered.

"Sir Seneschal," said Osmond, seeing a broad portly old man, with grey hair and a golden chain, "this is the Duke of Normandy—I pray you conduct him to the King's presence."

Richard had no longer any cause to complain of neglect, for the Seneschal instantly made him a very low bow, and calling "Place—place for the high and mighty Prince, my Lord Duke of Normandy!" ushered him up to the dais or raised part of the floor, where the King and Queen stood together talking. The Queen looked round, as Richard was announced, and he saw her face, which was sallow, and with a sharp sour expression that did not please him, and he backed and looked reluctant, while Osmond, with a warning hand pressed on his shoulder, was trying to remind him that he ought to go forward, kneel on one knee, and kiss her hand.

"There he is," said the King.

"One thing secure!" said the Queen; "but what makes that northern giant keep close to his heels?"

Louis answered something in a low voice, and, in the meantime, Osmond tried in a whisper to induce his young Lord to go forward and perform his obeisance.

"I tell you I will not," said Richard. "She looks cross, and I do not like her."

Luckily he spoke his own language; but his look and air expressed a good deal of what he said, and Gerberge looked all the more unattractive.

"A thorough little Norwegian bear," said the King; "fierce and unruly as the rest. Come, and perform your courtesy—do you forget where you are?" he added, sternly.

Richard bowed, partly because Osmond forced down his shoulder; but he thought of old Rollo and Charles the Simple, and his proud heart resolved that he would never kiss the hand of that sour-looking Queen. It was a determination made in pride and defiance, and he suffered for it afterwards; but no more passed now, for the Queen only saw in his behaviour that of an unmannerly young Northman: and though she disliked and despised him, she did not care enough about his courtesy to insist on its being paid. She sat down, and so did the King, and they went on talking; the King probably telling her his adventures at Rouen, while Richard stood on the step of the dais, swelling with sullen pride.

Nearly a quarter of an hour had passed in this manner when the servants came to set the table for supper, and Richard, in spite of his indignant looks, was forced to stand aside. He wondered that all this time he had not seen the two Princes, thinking how strange he should have thought it, to let his own dear father be in the house so long without coming to welcome him. At last, just as the supper had been served up, a side door opened, and the Seneschal called, “Place for the high and mighty Princes, my Lord Lothaire and my Lord Carloman!” and in walked two boys, one about the same age as Richard, the other rather less than a year younger. They were both thin, pale, sharp-featured children, and Richard drew himself up to his full height, with great satisfaction at being so much taller than Lothaire.

They came up ceremoniously to their father and kissed his hand, while he kissed their foreheads, and then said to them, “There is a new play-fellow for you.”

“Is that the little Northman?” said Carloman, turning to stare at Richard with a look of curiosity, while Richard in his turn felt considerably affronted that a boy so much less than himself should call him little.

“Yes,” said the Queen; “your father has brought him home with him.”

Carloman stepped forward, shyly holding out his hand to the stranger, but his brother pushed him rudely aside. “I am the eldest; it is my business to be first. So, young Northman, you are come here for us to play with.”

Richard was too much amazed at being spoken to in this imperious way to make any answer. He was completely taken by surprise, and only opened his great blue eyes to their utmost extent.

“Ha! why don’t you answer? Don’t you hear? Can you speak only your own heathen tongue?” continued Lothaire.

“The Norman is no heathen tongue!” said Richard, at once breaking silence in a loud voice. “We are as good Christians as you are—ay, and better too.”

“Hush! hush! my Lord!” said Osmond.

“What now, Sir Duke,” again interfered the King, in an angry tone, “are you brawling already? Time, indeed, I should take you from your own savage court. Sir Squire, look to it, that you keep your charge in better rule, or I shall send him instantly to bed, supperless.”

“My Lord, my Lord,” whispered Osmond, “see you not that you are bringing discredit on all of us?”

“I would be courteous enough, if they would be courteous to me,” returned Richard, gazing with eyes full of defiance at Lothaire, who, returning an angry look, had nevertheless shrunk back to his mother. She meanwhile was saying, “So strong, so rough, the young savage is, he will surely harm our poor boys!”

“Never fear,” said Louis; “he shall be watched. And,” he added in a lower tone, “for the present, at least, we must keep up appearances. Hubert of Senlis, and Hugh of Paris, have their eyes on us, and were the boy to be missed, the grim old Harcourt would have all the pirates of his land on us in the twinkling of an eye. We have him, and there we must rest content for the present. Now to supper.”

> **Stop here: first half of chapter 6.** Narrate. Week 12: the second half, supper with Carloman and bedtime at Laon.

OPEN YOUR COPY · THURSDAY

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 9

Holling C. Holling — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Tree in the Trail to chapter 9.

One sitting, ~15–20 min. Read once, narrate, stop.

Catch-up: Weeks 3–10 were ch. 1–8. Keep going in order. Do not jump to AO Week 11's ch. 16.

Never reprint Holling.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. First sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 35) · *Little Duke* (sitting 2, printed) · *Burgess* ch. 11 (printed; ch. 12 optional) · Grimm's Pantheon · Rockwell *Saying Grace* (book or screen) · Bernstein *On the Waterfront* suite · index cards, glue, Wednesday's treasures · *Betsy* (afternoon) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Red and gold leaves; squirrels with acorns.

8:25 **Hymn · lighter Bible day**

Sing stanzas 1–2. No new passage today.

8:35 **Ray's · Lesson 35**

One lesson. Oral first.

8:55 **Tales · Little Duke ch. 6a, sitting 2**

Printed, from "Thus they travelled." Laon, the Queen, and the two princes. ~8 min. Narrate.

9:10 **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 11** TRACY JOINS

A Fellow With a Thousand Spears (the porcupine). Printed. Narrate. Ch. 12 (the beaver) only if she asks for more, or if ch. 11 was read last week.

9:35 **Grimm · by title** TRACY JOINS

From your Pantheon. "The Fisherman and His Wife" suggested. One tale. Narrate.

9:50 **Picture study + composer** TRACY JOINS

Rockwell *Saying Grace*: look, turn it over, describe it. Then the opening of Bernstein's *On the Waterfront* suite while she draws.

10:10 **Handicraft · place cards** TRACY JOINS

Fold, write names, glue one treasure each. Twenty minutes, then stop. *Afternoon:* Betsy sitting 2.

How to teach Friday

> **No Awana. Lighter Bible.** Two printed readings this morning (Little Duke and Burgess), so give each its own narration with a song or a stretch between. Betsy's second sitting is an afternoon read-aloud.

Little Duke

They reach the royal castle of Laon. The Queen looks Richard over coldly, and the King laughs and calls him a little Norwegian bear. The princes come in: proud Lothaire, who orders Richard about and calls Norman a heathen tongue, and shy little Carloman, who wants to be friends. Richard answers hotly, and Osmond and the King both scold. Ask her which prince she would want for a friend.

Burgess

Ch. 11 is the week's chapter: Prickly Porky the Porcupine, his quills, and why nobody hurries him. Porcupines live in the Texas Hill Country to the west, so you probably won't meet one here. If you already read it as Week 10's optional, review it in one minute and go on to ch. 12, Paddy the Beaver. Beavers do live along the Colorado River near Bastrop.

Grimm

"The Fisherman and His Wife" (or "The Star-Money" / "Sweet Porridge" if it's familiar). One tale. Close the book. Let her tell it.

Picture study and composer

Saying Grace: an old woman and a little boy bow their heads to pray at a table in a crowded, smoky railroad-town diner while rough young men and travelers stare. Ask what she noticed first and how the people watching might feel. The *On the Waterfront* suite opens with a lonely horn, then grows loud and fierce. Play the quiet start; turn it down if it gets too big.

Betsy, sitting 2 (afternoon)

From "Betsy stopped short" to the break before "Betsy mounted on a soap box." The Wendells have gone, the girls are eight miles from home with only a few cents, and Betsy decides to find work. It's worrying; stop and tell her tomorrow brings the rest.

Tracy: nature, hymn, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, music, place cards. McGuffey during Ray's and Little Duke.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 11 · A Fellow With a Thousand Spears

*Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. XI, **pp. 90–98**. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. Full chapter (printed as optional in Week 10). · This packet: pp. 34–36*

“There,” said Old Mother Nature, pointing to Prickly Porky the Porcupine, “is next to the largest member of your order, which is?”

“Order of Rodents,” piped up Striped Chipmunk.

“He is not only next to the largest, but is the stupidest,” continued Old Mother Nature. “At least that is what people say of him, though I suspect he isn’t as stupid as he sometimes seems. Anyway, he manages to keep well fed and escape his enemies, which is more than can be said for some others who are supposed to have quick wits.”

“Escaping his enemies is no credit to him. They are only too glad to keep out of his way; he doesn’t have to fear anybody,” said Chatterer the Red Squirrel to his cousin, Happy Jack.

His remark didn’t escape the keen ears of Old Mother Nature. “Are you sure about that?” she demanded. “Now there’s Pekan the Fisher-”

She was interrupted by a great rattling on the old stump. Everybody turned to look. There was Prickly Porky backing down as fast as he could, which wasn’t fast at all, and rattling his thousand little spears as he did so. It was really very funny. Everybody had to laugh, even Old Mother Nature. You see, it was plain that he was in a great hurry, yet every movement was slow and clumsy.

“Well, Prickly Porky, what does this mean? Where are you going?” demanded Old Mother Nature.

Prickly Porky turned his dull-looking eyes towards her, and in them was a troubled, worried look. “Where’s Pekan the Fisher?” he asked, and his voice shook a little with something very much like fear.

Old Mother Nature understood instantly. When she had said, “Now there’s Pekan the Fisher,” Prickly Porky had waited to hear no more. He had instantly thought that she meant that Pekan was right there somewhere. “It’s all right, Prickly Porky,” said she. “Pekan isn’t anywhere around here, so climb back on that stump and don’t worry. Had you waited for me to finish, you would have saved yourself a fright. Chatterer had just said that you didn’t have to fear anybody and I was starting to explain that he was wrong, that despite your thousand little spears you have reason to fear Pekan the Fisher.”

Prickly Porky shivered and this made the thousand little spears in his coat rattle. It was such a surprising thing to see Prickly Porky actually afraid that the other little folks almost doubted their own eyes. “Are you quite sure that Pekan isn’t anywhere around?” asked Prickly Porky, and his voice still shook.

“Quite sure,” replied Old Mother Nature. “If he were I wouldn’t allow him to hurt you. You ought to know that. Now sit up so that every one can get a good look at you.”

Prickly Porky sat up, and the others gathered around the foot of the stump to look at him. “He certainly is no beauty,” murmured Happy Jack Squirrel.

Happy Jack was quite right. He was anything but handsome. The truth is he was the homeliest, clumsiest-looking fellow in all the Green Forest. He was a little bigger than Bobby Coon and his body was thick and heavy-looking. His back humped up like an arch. His head was rather small for the size of his body, short and rather round. His neck was even shorter. His eyes were small and very dull. It was plain that he couldn’t see far, or clearly unless what he was

looking at was close at hand. His ears were small and nearly hidden in hair. His front teeth, the gnawing teeth which showed him to be a Rodent, were very large and bright orange. His legs were short and stout. He had four toes on each front foot and five on each hind foot, and these were armed with quite long, stout claws.

But the queerest thing and the most interesting thing about Prickly Porky was his coat. Not one among the other little people of the Green Forest has a coat anything like his. Most of them have a soft, short under fur protected and more or less hidden by longer, coarser hair. Prickly Porky had the long coarse hair and on his back it was very long and coarse, brownish-black in color up to the tips, which were white. Under this long hair was some soft woolly fur, but what that long hair hid chiefly was an array of wicked-looking little spears called quills. They were white to the tips, which were dark and very, very sharply pointed. All down the sides were tiny barbs, so small as hardly to be seen, but there just the same. On his head the quills were about an inch long, but on his back they were four inches long, becoming shorter towards the tail. The latter was rather short, stout, and covered with short quills.

As he sat there on that old stump some of Prickly Porky's little spears could be seen peeping out from the long hair on his back, but they didn't look particularly dangerous. Peter Rabbit suddenly made a discovery. "Why!" he exclaimed. "He hasn't any little spears on the under side of him!"

"I wondered who would be the first to notice that," said Old Mother Nature. "No, Prickly Porky hasn't any little spears underneath, and Pekan the Fisher has found that out. He knows that if he can turn Prickly Porky on his back he can kill him without much danger from those little spears, and he has learned how to do that very thing. That is why Prickly Porky is afraid of him. Now, Prickly Porky, climb down off that stump and show these little folks what you do when an enemy comes near."

Grumbling and growling, Prickly Porky climbed down to the ground. Then he tucked his head down between his front paws and suddenly the thousand little spears appeared all over him, pointing in every direction until he looked like a giant chestnut burr. Then he began to thrash his tail from side to side.

"What is he doing that for?" asked Johnny Chuck, looking rather puzzled.

"Go near enough to be hit by it, and you'll understand," said Old Mother Nature dryly. "That is his one weapon. Whoever is hit by that tail will find himself full of those little spears and will take care never to go near Prickly Porky again. Once those little spears have entered the skin, they keep working in deeper and deeper, and more than one of his enemies has been killed by them. On account of those tiny barbs they are hard to pull out, and pulling them out hurts dreadfully. Just try one and see."

But no one was anxious to try, so Old Mother Nature paused only a moment. "You will notice that he moves that tail quickly," she continued. "It is the only thing about him which is quick. When he has a chance, in time of danger, he likes to get his head under a log or rock, instead of putting it between his paws as he is doing now. Then he plants his feet firmly and waits for a chance to use that tail."

"Is it true that he can throw those little spears at folks?" asked Peter.

Old Mother Nature shook her head. "There isn't a word of truth in it," she declared. "That story probably was started by some one who was hit by his tail, and it was done so quickly that the victim didn't see the tail move and so thought the little spears were thrown at him."

"How does he make all those little spears stand up that way?" asked Jumper the Hare.

"He has a special set of muscles for just that purpose," explained Old Mother Nature.

"When those quills stick into some one they must pull out of Prickly Porky's own skin; I should think that would hurt him," spoke up Striped Chipmunk.

"Not at all," replied Old Mother Nature. "They are very loosely fastened in his skin and come out at the least little pull. New Ones grow to take the place of those he loses. Notice that he puts his whole foot flat on the ground just as Buster Bear and Bobby Coon do, and just as those two-legged creatures called men do. Very few animals do this, and

those that do are said to be plantigrade. Now, Prickly Porky, tell us what you eat and where you make your home, and that will end today's lesson."

"I eat bark, twigs and leaves mostly," grunted Prickly Porky ungraciously. "I like hemlock best of all, but also eat poplar, pine and other trees for a change. Sometimes I stay in a tree for days until I have stripped it of all its bark and leaves. I don't see any sense in moving about any more than is necessary."

"But that must kill the tree!" exclaimed Peter Rabbit.

"Well, what of it?" demanded Prickly Porky crossly. "There are plenty of trees. In summer I like lily pads and always get them when I can."

"Can you swim?" asked Peter eagerly.

"Of course," grunted Prickly Porky.

"I never see you out on the Green Meadows," said Peter.

"And you never will," retorted Prickly Porky. "The Green Forest for me every time. Summer or winter, I'm at home there."

"Don't you sleep through the cold weather the way Buster Bear and I do?" asked Johnny Chuck.

"What should I sleep for?" grumbled Prickly Porky. "Cold weather doesn't bother me. I like it. I have the Green Forest pretty much to myself then. I like to be alone. And as long as there are trees, there is plenty to eat. I sleep a great deal in the daytime because I like night best."

"What about your home?" asked Happy Jack.

"Home is wherever I happen to be, most of the time, but Mrs. Porky has a home in a hollow log or a cave or under the roots of a tree where the babies are born. I guess that's all I've got to tell you."

"You might add that those babies are big for the size of their mother and have a full supply of quills when they are born," said Old Mother Nature. "And you forgot to say how fond of salt you are, and how often this fondness gets you into trouble around the camps of men. Your fear of Pekan the Fisher we all saw. I might add that Puma the Panther is to be feared at times, and when he is very hungry Buster Bear will take a chance on turning you on your back. By the way, don't any of you call Prickly Porky a Hedgehog. He isn't any thing of the kind. He is sometimes called a Quill Pig, but his real name, Porcupine, is best. He has no near relatives. Tomorrow morning, instead of meeting here, we'll hold school on the shore of the pond Paddy the Beaver has made. School is dismissed."

> **End of chapter 11.** Narrate. Chapter 12 follows as an optional second sitting.

OPTIONAL · FRIDAY

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 12 · A Lumberman and Engineer

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. XII, ***pp. 99–111****. Optional second sitting. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 37–40*

Johnny Chuck and Striped Chipmunk were the only ones who were not on hand at the pond of Paddy the Beaver deep in the Green Forest at sun-up the next morning. Johnny and Striped Chipmunk were afraid to go so far from home. To the surprise of everybody, Prickly Porky was there.

“He must have traveled all night to get here he is such a slow-poke,” said Peter Rabbit to his cousin, Jumper the Hare.

Peter wasn’t far from the truth. But how ever he got there, there he was, reaching for lily pads from an old log which lay half in the water, and appearing very well satisfied with life. You know there is nothing like a good meal of things you like, to make everything seem just as it should.

Old Mother Nature seated herself on one end of Paddy’s dam and called the school to order. Just as she did so a brown head popped out of the water close by and a pair of anxious eyes looked up at Old Mother Nature.

“It is quite all right, Paddy,” said she softly. “These little folks are trying to gain a little knowledge of themselves and other folks, and we are going to have this morning’s lesson right here because it is to be about you.”

Paddy the Beaver no longer looked anxious. There was a sparkle in his eyes. “May I stay?” he asked eagerly. “If there is a chance to learn anything I don’t want to miss it.”

Before Old Mother Nature could reply Peter Rabbit spoke up. “But the lesson is to be about you and your family. Do you expect to learn anything about yourself?” he demanded, and chuckled as if he thought that a great joke.

“It seems to me that some one named Peter learned a great deal about his own family when he first came to school to me,” said Old Mother Nature. Peter had grace enough to hang his head and look ashamed. “Of course you may stay, Paddy. In fact, I want you to. There are some things I shall want you to explain. That is why we are holding school over here this morning. Just come up here on your dam where we can all get a good look at you.”

Paddy the Beaver climbed out on his dam. It was the first time Happy Jack Squirrel ever had seen him out of water, and Happy Jack gave a little gasp of surprise. “I had no idea he is so big!” he exclaimed.

“He is the biggest of all the Rodents in this country, and one of the biggest in all the Great World. Also he is the smartest member of the whole order,” said Old Mother Nature.

“He doesn’t look it,” said Chatterer the Squirrel with a saucy jerk of his tail.

“Which means, I suppose, that you haven’t the least doubt that you are quite as smart as he,” said Old Mother Nature quietly, and Chatterer looked both guilty and a little bit ashamed. “I’ll admit that you are smart, Chatterer, but often it is in a wrong way. Paddy is smart in the very best way. He is a lumberman, builder and engineer. A lot of my little people are workers, but they are destructive workers. The busier they are, the more they destroy. Paddy the Beaver is a constructive worker. That means that he is a builder instead of a destroyer.”

“How about all those trees he cuts down? If that isn’t destroying, I don’t know what is!” said Chatterer, and with each word jerked his tail as if somehow his tongue and tail were connected.

“So it is,” replied Old Mother Nature good-naturedly. “But just think of the number of trees you destroy.”

“I never have destroyed a tree in my life!” declared Chatterer indignantly.

“Yes, you have,” retorted Old Mother Nature.

“I never have!” contradicted Chatterer, quite forgetting to whom he was speaking.

But Old Mother Nature overlooked this. “I don’t suppose you ever ate a chestnut or a fat hickory nut or a sweet beechnut,” said she softly.

“Of course,” retorted Chatterer sharply. “I’ve eaten ever and ever and ever so many of them. What of it?”

In the heart of each one was a little tree, explained Old Mother Nature. “But for you very many of those little trees would have sprung up and some day would have made big trees. So you see for every tree Paddy has destroyed you probably have destroyed a hundred. You eat the nuts that you may live. Paddy cuts down the trees that he may live, for the bark of those trees is his food. Like Prickly Porky he lives chiefly on bark. But, unlike Prickly Porky, he doesn’t destroy a tree for the bark alone. He wastes nothing. He makes use of every bit of that tree. He does something for the Green Forest in return for the trees he takes.”

Chatterer looked at Happy Jack and blinked in a puzzled way. Happy Jack looked at Peter Rabbit and blinked. Peter looked at Jumper the Hare and blinked. Jumper looked at Prickly Porky and blinked. Then all looked at Paddy the Beaver and finally at Old Mother Nature, and all blinked. Old Mother Nature chuckled.

“Don’t you think the Green Forest is more beautiful because of this little pond?” she asked. Everybody nodded. “Of course,” she continued. “But there wouldn’t be any little pond here were it not for Paddy and the trees he has cut. He destroyed the trees in order to make the pond. That is what I meant when I called him a constructive worker. Now I want you all to take a good look at Paddy. Then he will show us just how as a lumberman he cuts trees, as a builder he constructs houses and dams, and as an engineer he digs canals.”

As Paddy sat there on his dam, he looked rather like a giant member of the Rat family, though his head was more like that of a Squirrel than a Rat. His body was very thick and heavy, and in color he was dark brown, lighter underneath than above. Squatting there on the dam his back was rounded. All together, he was a very clumsy-looking fellow.

Peter Rabbit appeared to be interested in just one thing, Paddy’s tail. He couldn’t keep his eyes off it.

Old Mother Nature noticed this. “Well, Peter,” said she, “what have you on your mind now?”

“That tail,” replied Peter. “That’s the queerest tail I’ve ever seen. I should think it would be heavy and dreadfully in the way.”

Old Mother Nature laughed. “If you ask him Paddy will tell you that that tail is the handiest tail in the Green Forest,” said she. “There isn’t another like it in all the Great World, and if you’ll be patient you will see just how handy it is.”

It was a queer-looking tail. It was broad and thick and flat, oval in shape, and covered with scales instead of hair. Just then Jumper the Hare made a discovery. “Why!” he exclaimed, “Paddy has feet like Honker the Goose!”

“Only my hind feet,” said Paddy. “They have webs between the toes just as Honker’s have. That is for swimming. But there are no webs between my fingers.” He held up a hand for all to see. Sure enough, the fingers were free.

“Now that everybody has had a good look at you, Paddy,” said Old Mother Nature, “suppose you swim over to where you have been cutting trees. We will join you there, and then you can show us just how you work.”

Paddy slipped into the water, where for a second or two he floated with just his head above the surface. Then he quickly raised his broad, heavy tail and brought it down on the water with a slap that sounded like the crack of a terrible gun. It was so loud and unexpected that every one save Old Mother Nature and Prickly Porky jumped with fright. Peter Rabbit happened to be right on the edge of the dam and, because he jumped before he had time to think, he jumped right into the water with a splash. Now Peter doesn’t like the water, as you know, and he scrambled out just as fast as ever he could. How the others did laugh at him.

“What did he do that for?” demanded Peter indignantly. “To show you one use he has for that handy tail,” replied Old Mother Nature. “That is the way he gives warning to his friends whenever he discovers danger. Did you notice how he used his tail to aid him in swimming? He turns it almost on edge and uses it as a rudder. Those big, webbed hind

feet are the paddles which drive him through the water. He can stay under water a long time—as much as five minutes. See, he has just come up now."

Sure enough, Paddy's head had just appeared clear across the pond almost to the opposite shore, and he was now swimming on the surface. Old Mother Nature at once led the way around the pond to a small grove of poplar trees which stood a little way back from the water. Paddy was already there. "Now," said Old Mother Nature "show us what kind of a lumberman you are."

Paddy picked out a small tree, sat up much as Happy Jack Squirrel does, but with his big flat tail on the ground to brace him, seized the trunk of the tree in both hands, and went to work with his great orange-colored cutting teeth. He bit out a big chip. Then another and another. Gradually he worked around the tree. After a while the tree began to sway and crack. Paddy bit out two or three more chips, then suddenly slapped the ground with his tail as a warning and scampered back to a safe distance. He was taking no chances of being caught under that falling tree.

The tree fell, and at once Paddy returned to work. The smaller branches he cut off with a single bite at the base of each. The larger ones required a number of bites. Then he set to work to cut the trunk up in short logs. At this point Old Mother Nature interrupted.

"Now show us," said she, "what you do with the logs."

Paddy at once got behind a log, and by pushing, rolled it ahead of him until at last it fell with a splash in the water of a ditch or canal which led from near that grove of trees to the pond. Paddy followed into the water and began to push it ahead of him towards the pond.

"That will do," spoke up Old Mother Nature. "Come out and show us how you take the branches."

Obediently Paddy climbed out and returned to the fallen tree. There he picked up one of the long branches in his mouth, grasping it near the butt, twisted it over his shoulder and started to drag it to the canal. When he reached the latter he entered the water and began swimming, still dragging the branch in the same way. Once more Old Mother Nature stopped him. "You've shown us how you cut trees and move them, so now I want you to answer a few questions," said she.

Paddy climbed out and squatted on the bank.

"How did this canal happen to be here handy?" asked Old Mother Nature.

"Why, I dug it, of course," replied Paddy looking surprised. "You see, I'm rather slow and clumsy on land, and don't like to be far from water. Those trees are pretty well back from the pond, so I dug this canal, which brings the water almost to them. It makes it safer for me in case Old Man Coyote or Buster Bear or Yowler the Bobcat happens to be looking for a Beaver dinner. Also it makes it very much easier to get my logs and branches to the pond."

Old Mother Nature nodded. "Just so," said she. "I want the rest of you to notice how well this canal has been dug. At the other end it is carried along the bottom of the pond where the water is shallow so as to give greater depth. Now you will understand why I called Paddy an engineer. What do you do with your logs and branches, Paddy?"

"Put them in my food-pile, out there where the water is deep near my house," replied Paddy promptly. "The bark I eat, and the bare sticks I use to keep my house and dam in repair. In the late fall I cut enough trees to keep me in food all winter. When my pond is covered with ice I have nothing to worry about; my food supply is below the ice. When I am hungry I swim out under the ice, get a stick, take it back into my house and eat the bark. Then I take the bare stick outside to use when needed on my dam or house."

"How did you come to make this fine pond?" asked Old Mother Nature.

"Oh, I just happened to come exploring up the Laughing Brook and found there was plenty of food here and a good place for a pond," replied Paddy. "I thought I would like to live here. Down where my dam is, the Laughing Brook was shallow—just the place for a dam."

"Tell us why you wanted a pond and how you built that dam," commanded Old Mother Nature.

“Why, I had to have a pond, if I was to stay here,” replied Paddy, as if every one must understand that. “The Laughing Brook wasn’t deep or big enough for me to live here safely. If it had been, I would have made my home in the bank and not bothered with a house or dam. But it wasn’t, so I had to make a pond. It required a lot of hard work, but it is worth all it cost.

“First, I cut a lot of brush and young trees and placed them in the Laughing Brook in that shallow place, with the butts pointing up-stream. I kept them in place by piling mud and stones on them. Then I kept piling on more sticks and brush and mud. The water brought down leaves and floating stuff, and this caught in the dam and helped fill it in. I dug a lot of mud in front of it and used this to fill in the spaces between the sticks. This made the water deeper in front of the dam and at the same time kept it from getting through. As the water backed up, of course it made a pond. I kept making my dam longer and higher, and the longer and higher it became the bigger the pond grew. When it was big enough and deep enough to suit me, I stopped work on the dam and built my house out there.”

Everybody turned to look at Paddy’s house, the roof of which stood high out of water a little way from the dam. “Tell us how you built that,” said Old Mother Nature quietly.

“Oh, I just made a big platform of sticks and mud out there where it was deep enough for me to be sure that the water could not freeze clear to the bottom, even in the coldest weather,” replied Paddy, in a matter-of-fact tone. “I built it up until it was above water. Then I built the walls and roof of sticks and mud, just as you see them there. Inside I have a fine big room with a comfortable bed of shredded wood. I have two openings in the floor with a long passage leading from each down through the foundations and opening at the bottom of the pond. Of course, these are filled with water. Some houses have only one passage, but I like two. These are the only entrances to my house.

“Every fall I repair my walls and roof, adding sticks and mud and turf, so that now they are very thick. Late in the fall I sometimes plaster the outside with mud. This freezes hard, and no enemy who may reach my house on the ice can tear it open. I guess that’s all.”

Peter Rabbit drew a long breath. “What dreadful lot of work,” said he. “Do you work all the time?”

Paddy chuckled. “No, Peter,” said he. And Old Mother Nature nodded in approval. “Quite right,” said she. “Quite right. Are there any more questions?”

“Do you eat nothing but bark?” It was Happy Jack Squirrel who spoke.

“Oh, no,” replied Paddy. “In summer I eat berries, mushrooms, grass and the leaves and stems of a number of plants. In winter I vary my fare with lily roots and the roots of alder and willow. But bark is my principal food.”

Old Mother Nature waited a few minutes, but as there were no more questions she added a few words. “Now I hope you understand why I am so proud of Paddy the Beaver, and why I told you that he is a lumberman, builder and engineer,” said she. “For the next lesson we will take up the Rat family.”

> **End of chapter 12.** If you skip it, it opens Week 12.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Grimm’s Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

Pantheon edition · owned copy · by title only · never reprinted

Open your Pantheon Grimm.

Suggested: *The Fisherman and His Wife*. Alternates: *The Star-Money* or *Sweet Porridge* if it’s familiar.

Find it by title in the contents. Read once. Close the book. Narrate. Never reprint.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · Ray's (Lesson 36) · Harvey's · *Understood Betsy* ch. 10 (printed, sitting 3) · *Pilgrim's Progress* (printed) · Hillyer CHOW (your copy) · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. One bird, one leaf. Draw one thing later.

8:25 — **Bible · Luke 22:14–38**

The Last Supper; who is the greatest; Peter warned. Read once, narrate the main thread, stop.

8:40 — **Hymn or folk song** TRACY JOINS

Whichever she asks for.

8:50 — **Ray's · Lesson 36**

One lesson. Oral first. That finishes this week's four.

9:10 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

Second sitting of the week. Ten minutes.

9:25 — **Understood Betsy ch. 10 (sitting 3)**

Printed, from "Betsy mounted on a soap box" to the end (~15 min). Narrate. A very happy ending.

9:45 — **Pilgrim's Progress**

The iron cage, the Judgment dream, farewell to the Interpreter. Printed, about 1,300 words. Narrate. May split after the iron cage.

10:05 — **CHOW · A Great Adventure**

From your Hillyer. One sitting, ~15 min. Narrate. Never reprint. Dictation is optional today; skip it if the morning is full.

How to teach Saturday

> **Luke, Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, and Hillyer.** Harvey's second sitting. If the day is busy, keep Bible, Ray's, and Betsy, and save CHOW for Week 12.

Bible

Luke 22:14–38. Open your ESV. Jesus eats the Passover with the apostles and gives them the bread and the cup. The disciples argue about who is greatest, and Jesus says the greatest is the one who serves. He tells Peter he will deny Him three times before the rooster crows. One reading. Narrate the main thread.

Understood Betsy

Betsy washes dishes at a lunch counter and earns the train fare. The girls ride home, and Uncle Henry meets them, frantic with worry. Then he tells the whole story to Aunt Abigail and Cousin Ann, and even Cousin Ann says she has never heard of a child doing a smarter, grittier thing. Ask her what Betsy remembered about Cousin Ann when she was stuck.

Pilgrim's Progress

The man in the iron cage once was a hopeful pilgrim and now cannot repent. The second man tells his dream of the Judgment and wakes up afraid. Let her narrate the pictures. If she asks about the dream, the Interpreter's answer is enough: these sights are meant to keep Christian walking on. Next time: the Cross.

CHOW

"A Great Adventure," from your own copy. Hillyer tells about the First Crusade. One sitting. Pre-read for the battle parts. Never reprint.

Dictation (optional)

Prepared dictation from *In from the dark ivy hopped a / Wee small bird: and that was Me.* Five minutes, only if she is fresh.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she'll sit, song, maybe Betsy listening. McGuffey during Ray's, Harvey's, and CHOW. Week 12 (Dec 9–12) brings Exodus 37–40, Luke 22:39–46, Island Story ch. 32, and Little Duke ch. 6 second half.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Bible · Luke 22:14–38

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 22:14–38.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The Last Supper; the greatest is the one who serves; Peter warned. Read once, narrate the main thread.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

The Pilgrim’s Progress · The iron cage, the dream of the Judgment, and farewell to the Interpreter

John Bunyan, The Pilgrim’s Progress (London: J. M. Dent; New York: E. P. Dutton, 1910 edition, illustrated by Frank C. Papé), ***pp. 36–39****. Text: Project Gutenberg #131 (bracketed Scripture references and section numbers removed). Public domain. About 1,300 words; may be split. · This packet: pp. 45–46*

Now, said Christian, let me go hence. Nay, stay, said the Interpreter, till I have shewed thee a little more, and after that thou shalt go on thy way. So he took him by the hand again, and led him into a very dark room, where there sat a man in an iron cage.

Now the man, to look on, seemed very sad; he sat with his eyes looking down to the ground, his hands folded together, and he sighed as if he would break his heart. Then said Christian, What means this? At which the Interpreter bid him talk with the man.

Then said Christian to the man, What art thou? The man answered, I am what I was not once.

CHR. What wast thou once?

MAN. The man said, I was once a fair and flourishing professor, both in mine own eyes, and also in the eyes of others; I once was, as I thought, fair for the Celestial City, and had then even joy at the thoughts that I should get thither.

CHR. Well, but what art thou now?

MAN. I am now a man of despair, and am shut up in it, as in this iron cage. I cannot get out. Oh, now I cannot!

CHR. But how camest thou in this condition?

MAN. I left off to watch and be sober. I laid the reins, upon the neck of my lusts; I sinned against the light of the Word and the goodness of God; I have grieved the Spirit, and he is gone; I tempted the devil, and he is come to me; I have provoked God to anger, and he has left me: I have so hardened my heart, that I cannot repent.

Then said Christian to the Interpreter, But is there no hope for such a man as this? Ask him, said the Interpreter. Nay, said Christian, pray, Sir, do you.

INTER. Then said the Interpreter, Is there no hope, but you must be kept in the iron cage of despair?

MAN. No, none at all.

INTER. Why, the Son of the Blessed is very pitiful.

MAN. I have crucified him to myself afresh; I have despised his person; I have despised his righteousness; I have “counted his blood an unholy thing”; I have “done despite to the Spirit of grace”. Therefore I have shut myself out of all the promises, and there now remains to me nothing but threatenings, dreadful threatenings, fearful threatenings, of certain judgement and fiery indignation, which shall devour me as an adversary.

INTER. For what did you bring yourself into this condition?

MAN. For the lusts, pleasures, and profits of this world; in the enjoyment of which I did then promise myself much delight; but now every one of those things also bite me, and gnaw me like a burning worm.

INTER. But canst thou not now repent and turn?

MAN. God hath denied me repentance. His Word gives me no encouragement to believe; yea, himself hath shut me up in this iron cage; nor can all the men in the world let me out. O eternity, eternity! how shall I grapple with the misery that I must meet with in eternity!

INTER. Then said the Interpreter to Christian, Let this man's misery be remembered by thee, and be an everlasting caution to thee.

CHR. Well, said Christian, this is fearful! God help me to watch and be sober, and to pray that I may shun the cause of this man's misery! Sir, is it not time for me to go on my way now?

INTER. Tarry till I shall show thee one thing more, and then thou shalt go on thy way.

> **Optional break.** If she is tired, stop here and read the dream another day.

SECOND SITTING

So he took Christian by the hand again, and led him into a chamber, where there was one rising out of bed; and as he put on his raiment, he shook and trembled. Then said Christian, Why doth this man thus tremble? The Interpreter then bid him tell to Christian the reason of his so doing. So he began and said, This night, as I was in my sleep, I dreamed, and behold the heavens grew exceeding black; also it thundered and lightened in most fearful wise, that it put me into an agony; so I looked up in my dream, and saw the clouds rack at an unusual rate, upon which I heard a great sound of a trumpet, and saw also a man sit upon a cloud, attended with the thousands of heaven; they were all in flaming fire: also the heavens were in a burning flame. I heard then a voice saying, "Arise, ye dead, and come to judgement"; and with that the rocks rent, the graves opened, and the dead that were therein came forth. Some of them were exceeding glad, and looked upward; and some sought to hide themselves under the mountains. Then I saw the man that sat upon the cloud open the book, and bid the world draw near. Yet there was, by reason of a fierce flame which issued out and came from before him, a convenient distance betwixt him and them, as betwixt the judge and the prisoners at the bar. I heard it also proclaimed to them that attended on the man that sat on the cloud, Gather together the tares, the chaff, and stubble, and cast them into the burning lake. And with that, the bottomless pit opened, just whereabout I stood; out of the mouth of which there came, in an abundant manner, smoke and coals of fire, with hideous noises. It was also said to the same persons, "Gather my wheat into the garner." And with that I saw many catched up and carried away into the clouds, but I was left behind. I also sought to hide myself, but I could not, for the man that sat upon the cloud still kept his eye upon me; my sins also came into my mind; and my conscience did accuse me on every side. Upon this I awaked from my sleep.

CHR. But what is it that made you so afraid of this sight?

MAN. Why, I thought that the day of judgement was come, and that I was not ready for it: but this frighted me most, that the angels gathered up several, and left me behind; also the pit of hell opened her mouth just where I stood. My conscience, too, afflicted me; and, as I thought, the Judge had always his eye upon me, shewing indignation in his countenance.

Then said the Interpreter to Christian, Hast thou considered all these things?

CHR. Yes, and they put me in hope and fear.

INTER. Well, keep all things so in thy mind that they may be as a goad in thy sides, to prick thee forward in the way thou must go. Then Christian began to gird up his loins, and to address himself to his journey. Then said the Interpreter, The Comforter be always with thee, good Christian, to guide thee in the way that leads to the City. So Christian went on his way, saying—

"Here I have seen things rare and profitable; Things pleasant, dreadful, things to make me stable In what I have begun to take in hand; Then let me think on them, and understand Wherefore they showed me were, and let me be Thankful, O good Interpreter, to thee."

> **Stop here.** Week 12: the Cross, where Christian's burden falls off.

OPEN YOUR COPY · SATURDAY

A Child’s History of the World · A Great Adventure

V. M. Hillyer — owned copy · ch. 53 in newer printings, ch. 51 in the 1924 first edition · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Hillyer to “A Great Adventure.”

One sitting, ~15 min. Read once, close the book, narrate, stop.

Follows Week 10’s “A Pirate’s Great Grandson.” The First Crusade: pre-read the battle parts.

Never reprint Hillyer from your copy.

READ THIS · SATURDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. Second sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

HOLD ALL WEEK · FROM YOUR SHELF

Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic · Lessons 33–36

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

One lesson each school day.

Wednesday Lesson 33 · Thursday Lesson 34 · Friday Lesson 35 · Saturday Lesson 36.

Oral first when the book allows. Stop after one lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-pages nearby.

Do not dump the book. Never reprint Mott text.

WED + THU ONLY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Awana workbook

Physical workbook · never reprinted

After Bible, Wed and Thu only.

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page or section in their physical Awana book. Then put it away.

No Awana Friday or Saturday. Never reprint Awana.